



WARCRAFT III

It's finally out and it's worth the wait

One of the most anticipated games, from one of the most revered game development units, is the epic *Warcraft III*. Developer Blizzard has crafted this game with amazing production values, boasting totally rendered 3D graphics, a new game system and four playable races.

Warcraft III reminds one a little of *Diablo* with its role playing elements like quests, experience points and character development. The campaigns are well laid out—you'll progress from controlling the Humans, to the Undead, to the Orcs and finally the Night Elves as you save the world from the hands of the Burning Legion. The single player missions have a lot of variety in them, with hack-n-slash gameplay, to search and rescue missions.

The game cashes in on its production values. All the races are unique in the way

their function and personality is stylised. The story is pushed forward through cut-scenes; both rendered and in-game, and a compelling storyline that keeps you up till the wee hours. The voice acting and soundtrack is top-notch too, and lend well to the pace of the game.

The game wins over its fan base with the multiplayer option—players can connect to *Battle.net* and play against others from across the globe, or just have a LAN skirmish. You can even record the multiplayer game and view it later, a feature that is going to make for some crazy RTS strategies and counter strategies. Another winning feature is the world editor, which allows you to make your own maps and in-game cut scenes.

At Rs 1,499, it's a little expensive, though each pack comes with a poster, an



ACTION! In-game cinematics and cutscenes such as these will keep you hooked to *Warcraft III*

extensive manual and mini books. *Warcraft III* is a finely tuned game with loads of polish and presentation, something you simply cannot afford to miss.

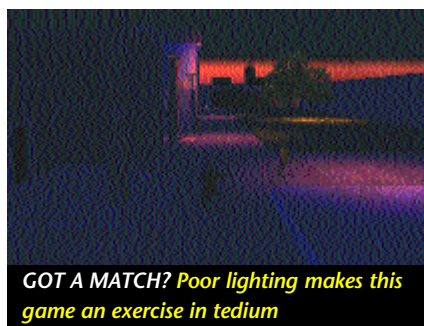
Genre: Real Time Strategy ■ **Developer:** Blizzard ■ **Distributor:** Worldwide CD Roms ■ **Phone:** 022-6973994/95
Web site: www.blizzard.com/warIII ■ **Price:** Rs 1,499 ■ ★★★★★

BHAGAT SINGH THE GAME

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The package says 'For the Hardcore Indian'. If being a patriot includes the ability to stand tedious gameplay, poor graphics, bad AI, bugs, boring level design, and an intrinsically flawed weapons and health system, then this game is really hardcore!

The storyline is based on incidents from Bhagat Singh's life, such as his assassination of General Saunders. It's a first-time effort and the inexperience shows in every aspect of the game. Playing the game is a dizzying ordeal. The keyboard settings are un-configurable—



GOT A MATCH? Poor lighting makes this game an exercise in tedium

the strafe keys are on one side of the keyboard and the direction keys on another.

The gameplay moves at one-third the speed of a normal FPS and is compounded with bad voice acting, poor lighting and level design that leaves you fumbling in the dark, guided by a voice that says "Bhagat, main Durgadevi bol rahi hoon, upar aa jao." Enemy AI is non-existent; the enemies just stand and shoot at you aimlessly, while mouthing catchphrases. The health system consists of killing white enemies and walking over them. We'd say that all the love for your country wouldn't make you complete this game.

Genre: First Person Shooter ■ **Developer:** Mitashi Edutainment ■ **Distributor:** Mitashi Edutainment ■ **Phone:** 022-5006661
Price: Rs 395 ■ ★☆☆☆☆